

ECON 345: Project Description

The broad objectives of this assignment is to apply the coding skills you learned in this course to explore economic questions with analysis of real-world data in collaboration with Atlanta Fed economists and instructors. In doing so, you will demonstrate proficiency in data management, especially creating, cleaning, and merging data, and presenting informative patterns in the data within the context of a policy-relevant research question. More concretely, you'll produce and interpret summary statistics, descriptive plots, comparative plots, and t-tests to elucidate insights about your research question. Of course, the analysis is only half the battle—research must be effectively communicated to be high-quality.

You'll be paired with an Atlanta Fed Economist to mentor and guide you with this project. They will provide you with a research proposal dealing with a topic and question that they have extensively explored. Your mentor will also provide you with the data needed to examine your research question and assist you in developing the empirical strategy that best accomplishes this. Data analysis is a difficult task that is littered with various roadblocks—you should lean on your mentor's wisdom and expertise to help you surmount these. You should remain in constant contact with your mentor throughout the course. In addition to various in-class meetings, you should email your mentor at least once per week and look to meet in-person as often as your schedules allow.

Project Deliverables

- Weekly homework assignments
- Six graded project updates (Project update #1 due September 19)
- Rough draft (Due 9:00am, November 13)
- Presentation (November 20, in class)
- Final paper (Due 9:00am, December 11)

Grading

In total, this research project is worth 65% of your final grade in the course. Six graded project updates account for 20%, and the rough draft, in-class presentation, and final paper together account for 45%. The criteria required for each assignment and the grading scale used for them are available on Canvas.

The rough draft of your project will be graded based on completion; however, you will also receive a mock final grade for this assignment and extensive feedback. This will be extremely valuable for you in revising your work to submit the final paper.